

Other punctuation

SLASHES, AT SIGNS, AMPERSANDS, AND ASTERISKS ARE A FEW OF THE LESS COMMONLY USED PUNCTUATION MARKS.

Slashes are used in web addresses, to show alternatives, to represent a period of time, and in units of measurement. “At” signs (@), ampersands (&), asterisks (*), and pound signs (#) usually represent omitted words or letters.

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The **at sign** was originally used to represent a **Spanish unit of weight** called an *arroba*.



Slashes in Internet addresses

Slashes are used to write Internet addresses. In this situation, they are called “forward slashes” and link the address of a minor page to that of a main site.

Style Skunks’ main website linked “news” page

www.styleskunks.com/news



Slashes for alternatives

Slashes are used to show alternatives such as *and/or* and *he/she*. These are found in technical documents, such as forms, or where space is limited, as in newspaper articles. It is usually better to write the alternatives out.

This means that she looked for shoes or hats, or both.

She looked for shoes *and/or* hats.



At signs

The at sign is used to write e-mail addresses. It separates the unique user name from the name of the host domain.

user name host domain

questions@styleskunks.com



Ampersands

The ampersand represents the word *and*. It is found in the names of businesses and organizations, and is used in academic references.

This could also be written “Squirrels and Swirls.”

She loved the fashion label Squirrels **&** Swirls.